

MMS & Emoji Features Guide - v1.4.0

Sending Images (MMS)

How to Send an Image

Step 1: Open Conversation

- Click on any driver in the left sidebar
- Conversation view opens on the right

Step 2: Attach Image

- Click the  **camera button** (left of text input)
- Your device's file picker opens
- Select an image file (JPEG, PNG, GIF)

Step 3: Preview

- Image preview appears below input field
- Shows: thumbnail, filename, file size
- Click ✕ to remove if you change your mind

Step 4: Send

- Add optional text message
- Or send image alone (text optional)
- Click **Send** button
- Image uploads and sends via MMS

Image Requirements

Supported Formats:

-  JPEG (.jpg, .jpeg)
-  PNG (.png)
-  GIF (.gif)
-  Video files (not supported yet)

-  Documents (not supported yet)

Size Limits:

- Maximum: 5MB per image
- Recommended: Under 2MB for faster sending
- Large images may take longer to upload
- Some carriers compress images automatically

Viewing Images

In Conversation Thread:

- Images display inline with messages
- Click any image to view full-size
- Opens in new browser tab
- Works for both sent and received images

Image Indicators:

- Sent images: Your theme color bubble
 - Received images: White bubble with border
 - " Image" text if image has no accompanying text
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Using the Emoji Picker

How to Use Emojis

Method 1: Emoji Picker

1. Click the  **emoji button** (left of camera button)
2. Emoji picker opens with 160+ emojis
3. Scroll through the grid
4. Click any emoji to insert
5. Emoji appears in your text input
6. Click outside picker to close

Method 2: Keyboard Emojis

- Use your device's emoji keyboard
- Windows: Win + . or Win + ;
- Mac: Cmd + Control + Space
- Mobile: Emoji button on keyboard

Available Emojis

Smileys & Emotion (40 emojis) 😊 😂 😍 😬 😎 😞 😡 😄 😍 😱 ...

Gestures & Hands (20 emojis) 👍 👊 🙌 🤝 🖐️ 🙏 🤞 🤟 🤘 ...

Symbols & Objects (40 emojis) ❤️ 🔥 ⭐ ✨ 💯 ✅ ❌ 🎉 ...

Vehicles & Transport (10 emojis) 🚗 🚙 🚌 🚝 🚊 🚒 ...

Tech & Communication (10 emojis) 📱 💻 📞 📧 📧 ...

Time & Calendar (10 emojis) ⌚ 📅 📅 📅 ...

Money & Business (10 emojis) 💰 💵 💳 💳 📈 ...

Weather & Nature (20 emojis) ☀️ 🌤️ 🌥️ 🌦️ 🌈 🌪️ ⚡ ...

Tips & Tricks

Emoji + Text:

- Mix emojis with text for expressive messages
- Example: "Great job today! 🎉 👍 "

Emoji Only:

- Send emoji reactions without text
- Example: 👍 (just thumbs up)

Multiple Emojis:

- Click multiple emojis before sending
- Example: 🔥 🔥 🔥 (emphasis)

Close Picker:

- Click outside the emoji grid
 - Click emoji button again
 - Start typing in message field
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Cost Considerations

SMS vs MMS Pricing

Standard SMS:

- Text only
- ~\$0.0079 per message
- No additional costs

MMS (with image):

- Text + image
- ~\$0.02 per message (varies by carrier)
- About 2.5x more expensive than SMS
- Worth it for visual communication!

Bulk Costs Example:

- 100 SMS messages: ~\$0.79
- 100 MMS messages: ~\$2.00
- 176 drivers (SMS): ~\$1.39
- 176 drivers (MMS): ~\$3.52

When to Use MMS

Good Use Cases:

-  Route maps or directions
-  Photos of delivery locations
-  Package condition documentation
-  Schedule screenshots

-  Important visual information

Maybe Use SMS Instead:

-  Simple text announcements
 -  Yes/no questions
 -  Bulk reminders
 -  When cost is a concern
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Technical Details

How Image Upload Works

Process:

1. You select image file
2. App reads file as base64 data
3. Sends to Twilio API with MediaUrl parameter
4. Twilio processes and delivers MMS
5. Image URL stored in conversation

Storage:

- Images hosted by Twilio
- Accessible via unique URL
- URLs cached in localStorage
- Available across devices

Receiving Images

Automatic:

- Background polling fetches new messages
- Checks for `num_media` field
- Downloads media URLs
- Displays in conversation thread

Frequency:

- Polls every 15 seconds
 - New images appear automatically
 - Sound notification plays (if enabled)
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 Visual Examples

Message Bubble Layouts

Text Only:

Hey, on my way!

Image Only:

 [Image]

Text + Image:

 [Image]

Here's the map!

Multiple Images:

 [Image 1]

 [Image 2]

Before & after

Mobile Experience

On Mobile Devices

Sending Images:

- Camera button opens photo picker
- Can choose from gallery or take new photo
- Preview shows before sending
- Tap to remove if needed

Viewing Images:

- Tap image to view full-screen
- Pinch to zoom
- Swipe to close
- Save to device option (browser dependent)

Emoji Picker:

- Scrollable grid works great on mobile
- Large touch targets
- Closes when tapping outside
- Native keyboard emojis also work

Troubleshooting

Image Won't Upload

Problem: "Image too large" error

- **Solution:** Image over 5MB, resize before sending
- Use image compression tool
- Most phone photos work fine

Problem: Upload fails

- **Solution:** Check internet connection
- Verify Twilio credentials in settings
- Check Twilio account has MMS enabled

Problem: Image not appearing

- **Solution:** Wait a few seconds for upload
- Hard refresh page (Ctrl+Shift+R)
- Check browser console (F12) for errors

Image Not Received

Problem: Sent image but driver didn't get it

- **Solution:** Check if driver's phone supports MMS
- Verify phone number is correct
- Some prepaid plans don't support MMS
- Check Twilio logs for delivery status

Problem: Can't see received images

- **Solution:** Hard refresh page
- Images from Twilio may be delayed
- Check browser console for media URLs

Emoji Issues

Problem: Emoji picker won't open

- **Solution:** Hard refresh page
- Check browser console for JavaScript errors
- Try different browser

Problem: Emojis look different

- **Solution:** Normal! Each device renders emojis differently
- iPhone vs Android show different styles
- Meaning is the same

Best Practices

For Drivers

When to Send Images:

- Delivery proof photos
- Address confusion
- Vehicle issues
- Route problems
- Package condition

Image Quality:

- Clear, well-lit photos
- Relevant to the message
- Not too large (< 2MB ideal)
- Compress if needed

For Managers

Bulk Messages:

- Use images sparingly in bulk sends
- Cost adds up quickly
- Save images for important announcements
- Consider SMS for routine messages

Documentation:

- Images provide visual proof
 - Better than text descriptions
 - Keep for records
 - Easy to reference later
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Pro Tips

Tip 1: Compress Images

- Use free online tools to compress
- Reduces file size
- Faster uploads
- Lower costs

Tip 2: Screenshot Text

- Complex schedules? Screenshot it!
- Route maps from GPS
- Information from other apps

Tip 3: Emoji Shortcuts

-  for confirmed
-  for problems
-  for location
-  for vehicle
-  for time

Tip 4: Mix Media

- Photo of location + address text
- Map image + arrival time
- Better communication = fewer questions

Tip 5: Preview Before Send

- Always check image preview
 - Verify it's the right image
 - Add descriptive text
 - Remove if wrong image selected
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Enjoy the new visual communication features! 📷 😊